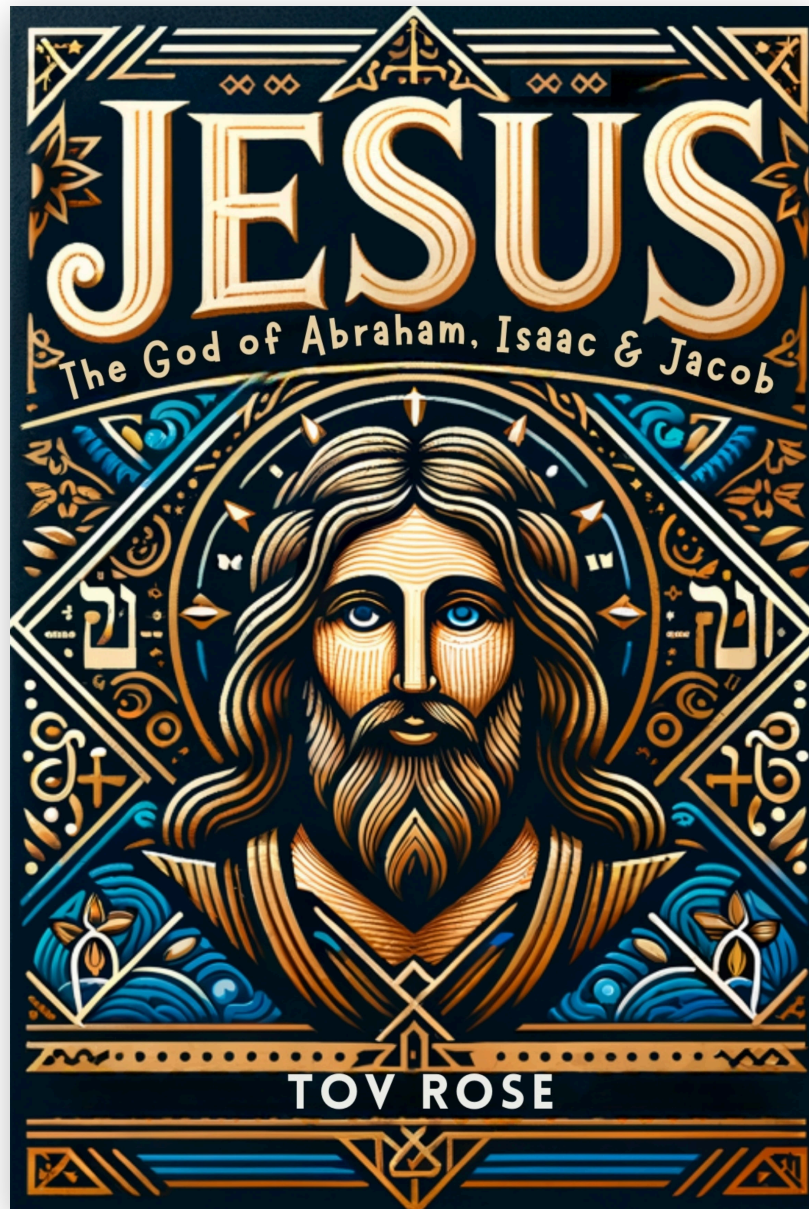


FREE CHAPTER



# Jesus: The God of Abraham, Isaac & Jacob

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Featuring the chapter: The God Revealed in the Old Testament

## About This Free Chapter

Was the God of the Old Testament actually Jesus — before Bethlehem? This chapter makes the case: the visible Yahweh who walked with Abraham, spoke from the burning bush, and appeared to Isaiah was the pre-incarnate Messiah.

It opens with a story that unlocks the Incarnation, then traces the evidence through Scripture — the Angel of the Lord, the “I AM” claims, the Rock that followed Israel through the wilderness. Read it in one sitting; familiar passages will not look the same afterward.

# The God Revealed in the Old Testament

## Was the One Who Became Jesus Messiah!

The following story, though fictional, eloquently illustrates a profound biblical truth. It was popularized by the late radio broadcaster Paul Harvey (Harvey, date unknown): There was a nonreligious skeptical man who just could not swallow the "Jesus story" about an Incarnation, about God coming to earth as a man. But one snowy evening he noticed a flock of birds huddled miserably in the snow, not having any shelter. Well, he could not let the poor creatures lie there and freeze, and he thought about his barn. That would provide a warm shelter if he could direct the birds to it.

Quickly he went to the barn, opened the doors wide and turned on a light, but the birds did not come in. He figured food would entice them in. So he hurried back to the house, found some bread crumbs that he sprinkled on the snow, making a trail to the doorway of the barn. But to his dismay, the birds ignored the bread crumbs, and continued to flap around helplessly in the snow. He tried catching them... He tried shooing them into the barn by walking around them waving his arms... Instead, they scattered in every direction, except into the warm, lighted barn.

And then, he realized that they were afraid of him. To them, he reasoned, I am a strange and terrifying creature. If only I could think of some way to let them know that they can trust me... That I am not trying to hurt them, but to help them. But how? Because any move he made tended to frighten them, they just would not follow. They would not be led or shooed because they feared him.

"If only I could be a bird," he thought to himself, "and mingle with them and speak their language. Then I could tell them not to be afraid. Then I could show them the way to the safe, warm barn. But I would have to be one of them so they could see, and hear and understand."

That thought became an epiphany. Stunned, he remembered the fundamental message: "And the Word became flesh and dwelt among us" (John 1:14) (Klink, 2016). Suddenly the gospel he had heard made complete sense! He dropped to his knees in the snow.

This story illustrates a key truth about how God chose to reveal Himself to humanity. The infinite, eternal Creator could not just directly manifest to finite creatures flooded with sin. We would be overwhelmed and condemned. So God chose to veil and limit Himself by taking on a human nature. As Emmanuel, "God with us," Jesus could fully reveal God's character in a way we could grasp and relate to (Isaiah 7:14, Matthew 1:23) (Grogan, 1986; Morris, 1992).

Throughout the Old Testament, Messiah appears as the visible Yahweh, the God who interacts with His people.

Jesus says, "Your father Abraham rejoiced to see My day, and he saw it and was glad." (John 8:56) (Klink, 2016).

Who did Abraham see? The pre-Incarnate Messiah.

The Angel of the Lord who spoke from the burning bush telling Moses He was the "I AM" was evidently the Eternal Word of God, Jehovah the Son, before His incarnation (Exodus 3:2,14) (Durham, 1987; Morgan, 1961). When Isaiah saw the Lord on His throne and cried out "Woe is me," this was another Old Testament appearance of the incarnate Son (Isaiah 6) (Oswalt, 1986).

The Ancient of Days in Daniel's vision is clearly God the

Father. But the "one like a Son of Man" who approaches His throne of judgment seems to be the second person of the Trinity prior to Bethlehem (Daniel 7:13-14) (Miller, 1994).

Though the label "Trinity" is never used, the Old Testament depicts God tri-personally and lays the groundwork that Jesus completes as the incarnate Son. God has progressively unveiled Himself while remaining transcendent mystery.

## **What Does the Bible Tell Us About the Father and the Son—the God Family?**

### **The Nature of God in the Old and New Testaments**

There is much confusion about the nature of God.

Scripture reveals that there is only one God

(Deuteronomy 6:4), yet this one God exists in plurality as the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit (Matthew 28:19) (Erickson, 1998). The Son is also called "the Word" who became Jesus Messiah (John 1:1, 14) (Klink, 2016). The Father and Son are "one" in essence, united in being, purpose, and mission, though distinct in person (John 10:30) (Grudem, 1994).

Notice the plural pronouns in Genesis 1:26: "Then God said, 'Let Us make man in Our image, according to Our likeness'" (Waltke, 2001). This intimates plurality within the one God even at creation.

A widespread misconception is that the God of the Old Testament was primarily harsh and legalistic, while Jesus in the New Testament is gracious, merciful, and loving (Smith, 1993). But this stereotype is not biblically accurate. Continuity exists between the testaments in how God relates to His people, even as the incarnation represents a new phase of revelation.

Can Scripture prove that Jesus existed prior to his human birth? Yes:

"And now, Father, glorify me in your presence with the glory I had with you before the world began." (John 17:5) (Klink, 2016).

"Father, I want those you have given me to be with me where I am, and to see my glory, the glory you have given me because you loved me before the creation of the world." (John 17:24) (Klink, 2016).

"He replied, 'I saw Satan fall like lightning from heaven.'" (Luke 10:18) (Bock, 1996). Here Jesus refers to Satan's fall before creation.

Many other verses confirm Messiah's preexistence (John 1:1-3; Philippians 2:5-7; Colossians 1:15-17) (Silva, 2005; O'Brien, 1991; Garland, 1998). His intimate knowledge of the Father also signifies his heavenly origin (Luke 10:22) (Bock, 1996).

The continuity between the testaments is upheld by the eternal Son as active agent in creation, revelation, and redemption throughout history. Apparent differences in the divine character reflect progressive unveiling of God's truth, humanity's changing needs, and the incarnation's new phase of mission.

### **Was Jesus Messiah Also God Before and After His Incarnation?**

The New Testament provides abundant evidence that Jesus Messiah existed as God prior to his human incarnation and continued as God afterwards.

Several verses speak of Messiah's preexistence:

"Behold, the virgin shall conceive and bear a son, and they shall call his name Immanuel" (which means, God with us). (Matthew 1:23) (Blomberg, 1992)

"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. He was in the beginning with God..." (John 1:1-2) (Klink, 2016)

"And the Word became flesh and dwelt among us, and we have seen his glory, glory as of the only Son from the Father, full of grace and truth." (John 1:14) (Klink, 2016)

"I and the Father are one." (John 10:30) (Klink, 2016)

John 1 shows two divine Beings existing "in the beginning" - the Word who became flesh as Jesus Messiah, and the Father. Messiah did not come into being at his birth, but is the eternal Word made incarnate (John 1:14).

Jesus performs divine functions that only God can do, like forgiving sins (Luke 5:24) and raising the dead (John 11:25) (Bock, 1996; Klink, 2016). He permits the worship of himself (Matthew 14:33; John 9:38) which is due to God alone (Bock, 1994; Klink, 2016).

The New Testament writers refer to Jesus as "God" specifically:

"To them belong the patriarchs, and from their race, according to the flesh, is the Messiah, who is God over all, blessed forever. Amen." (Romans 9:5) (Moo, 1996)

"Waiting for our blessed hope, the appearing of the glory of our great God and Savior Jesus Messiah." (Titus 2:13) (Towner, 2006)

"Simon Peter, a servant and apostle of Jesus Messiah, To those who have obtained a faith of equal standing with ours by the righteousness of our God and Savior Jesus Messiah." (2 Peter 1:1) (Green, 2008)

The preexistence, divine attributes, titles, honor, and functions ascribed to Jesus in the New Testament confirm that he is fully God, before and after the incarnation. This affirms the continuity of his eternal deity.

### **What Passages Most Clearly Show that Jesus Was the God of the Old Testament?**

Several key passages identify Jesus Messiah as the God who interacted with people in the Old Testament: "For I do not want you to be unaware, brothers, that our fathers were all under the cloud, and all passed through the sea, and all were baptized into Moses in the cloud and in the sea, and all ate the same spiritual food, and all drank the same spiritual drink. For they drank from the spiritual

Rock that followed them, and the Rock was Messiah." (1

Corinthians 10:1-4) (Garland, 2003)

Here Paul states that the God providing manna and water to the Israelites was Messiah. As the bread and water of life, Jesus was their spiritual sustenance.

"He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn of all creation. For by him all things were created, in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or dominions or rulers or authorities—all things were created through him and for him. And he is before all things, and in him all things hold together." (Colossians 1:15-17) (O'Brien, 1982)

This passage identifies Messiah as creator of all things, existing before all things eternally.

Throughout Hebrews 1, Jesus is worshipped as eternal

Creator God on his messianic throne (Psalm 45:6-7;

Psalm 102:25-27). (Guthrie, 1983)

Verses like John 1:3, Ephesians 3:9, and Hebrews 1:2 also attribute creation to Messiah.

In contrast, the Father is said to be invisible and has not been heard or seen by humans (John 1:18; 5:37; 6:46) (Klink, 2016). Therefore the visible, audible God of the Old Testament interacts as the pre-Incarnate Messiah, not the Father.

Jesus claims to be the divine "I AM" of Exodus 3:14 (John 8:58-59), angering the Jews by appropriating God's holy name (Klink, 2016). He also identifies himself with the same "I AM" formula in John 6:35; 8:12; 10:7,11;

11:25; 14:6; 15:1, linking himself to God's Old Testament self-revelation.

As both king and eternal high priest, Melchizedek foreshadows Messiah's messianic offices (Genesis 14:18; Hebrews 7:1-3) (Guthrie, 1983).

This evidence affirms that Jesus as the Word is the God predominantly active in the Old Testament. Knowing this affirms continuity between the testaments and the unified self-revelation of the one true God across redemptive history.

## What Comes Next

You have now seen the case: the God who showed up in the Old Testament was Jesus before Bethlehem. But this is one chapter. The full book goes much further — 385 prophecies fulfilled in Jesus, the Targum evidence, the Jewish wedding framework, and the controversy over the divine Name that led to a brand-new Bible translation.

### Get the full book

*Jesus: The God of Abraham, Isaac & Jacob* by Tov Rose — the complete case for Jesus as the God of the Old Testament, and the foundation of the New Messianic Version Bible.

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### Read the Bible it points to

**The New Messianic Version (NMV) Bible** — the translation that restores the names of God throughout the text. Read it free:

[bible.com/versions/2135-nmv-new-messianic-version-bible](https://bible.com/versions/2135-nmv-new-messianic-version-bible)